AI and the future of your work

How independent ownership and practical support can help people adapt

Titans Forge LLC | Updated September 26, 2026

If AI can do part of your job, what happens next? The answer depends partly on who owns it. Titans Forge supports a future in which people can own productive robots, local AI systems and businesses, and share in what those tools earn. People should have a route to building an independent livelihood.

What our report is asking

We are studying the path from what AI can do to what employers actually adopt, how they reorganize work and what happens to workers afterward. That means measuring hiring, hours, pay and movement into new roles alongside layoffs. A stable national job total can conceal serious disruption for a particular group.

What the evidence can tell us

The BLS report for August 2026 records 162,000 additional nonfarm payroll jobs and 4.1% unemployment. Those national figures describe the labor market; they cannot tell us how many jobs AI created or displaced. [1]

Census reported AI use by 19.8% of businesses in the period ending May 3, 2026. Business use is not the share of jobs automated. The survey broadened its question in November 2025, so comparisons across that change need care. [2]

How the same tool can lead to different outcomes

Consider an imaginary support team using AI to draft answers. It might handle more customers with the same staff, hire fewer people as it grows, or reduce headcount. The work still includes checking answers and handling difficult cases. Which path occurs depends on demand, reliability, management decisions and implementation costs. This is an illustration, not a measured case.

Our recommendations for dealing with job losses

Independent ownership should be a central part of the response. These are policy recommendations, not a prediction that every displaced worker can replace a salary with a robot.

- Help people buy productive tools. Pair ownership grants or fair equipment finance with installation, training and working capital. Test demand before taking on debt.
- Make ownership meaningful. Owners need practical rights to operate, repair and resell equipment, keep their business records and change suppliers. Endless mandatory subscriptions can undermine that control.
- Enable shared ownership. Workers can jointly own equipment or purchase an existing local business through a cooperative, with clear voting, use and income rights. USDA describes this ownership route. [3]
- Build a customer base. Combine equipment access with paid pilots, apprenticeships and local service contracts. The opportunity could include maintenance, fabrication or supervised automated services, depending on what the tools can reliably do.
- Support people through the change. Provide income support and paid training tied to real work, including childcare and transport. Help must also reach people who do not want to start a business.
- Share gains in existing firms. Encourage meaningful worker ownership, profit sharing and a say in how automation changes work. Protect workers from concentrating all their savings in their employer.

Start with the full cost of earning a living

Count repairs, software, power, insurance, financing, replacement costs and human time. A machine needs customers. A trial rental can be useful, but a permanent dependency on a vendor should not be the only way to work.

The SBA Microloan program is one existing route for eligible equipment purchases, with loans up to $50,000 through intermediaries. Approval and terms depend on the lender; new ownership grants would require separate funding. [4]

What workers and employers can ask now

- Which tasks are actually being changed? A tool trial and a dependable everyday workflow are different stages.
- Where does the saved time go? Track output, service quality and new responsibilities as well as staffing.
- Are opportunities changing? Fewer openings or fewer junior roles can matter before layoffs rise.
- What happens to affected workers? Measure time to a new job, retraining access and whether pay recovers.

Why robots need their own timeline

Software tools and physical robots face different costs and deployment steps. A robot may require equipment, installation, workplace changes and safety validation. Treating both as one adoption curve can hide the timing that matters to a worker or employer.

What comes next in the research

The next step is to link repeated measures of adoption with employment outcomes and compare otherwise similar firms or industries. We need to test whether changes started before AI adoption, account for other causes and follow workers through transitions. The report is a research framework, not a calibrated forecast of job losses through 2040.

Sources and further reading

1 Bureau of Labor Statistics | August Employment Situation | September 4 2026

2 US Census Bureau | Business AI use | May 26 2026

3 USDA Rural Development | Cooperative Services

4 Small Business Administration | Microloans

Companion research: AI, Robots, and the Labor Market - September 26, 2026 revision. Includes eight ownership and transition recommendations, a proposed local pilot, dated labor indicators and remaining scientific questions.